

PEAK Player Choice Analysis

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In PEAK, you are trying to climb a few mountains to reach the destination. You can play solo, but the game is built a lot around helping friends climb with you.

Player Actions:

- Climb
 - The player is choosing which path to take: Do you go straight up (short but risky) or go around (long but safer)? The player is also choosing when to sprint: Your stamina is spent more on sprinting and jumping. Sprinting saves time, but if you are out of stamina, you may lose a lot of progress.
- Scavenge
 - The player is choosing where to search: Do you detour to look for supplies, or keep climbing? Searching can give you items that save your run later, but detours add danger and cost energy
- Eat
 - The player is choosing whether to consume an item and which item to consume. You use food to restore stamina. Using food now is safe for the next climb segment. Saving food is risky now, but it can prevent you from running out later. Also, the game has “questionable food,” so eating can sometimes bring problems.
- Place climbing gear
 - The player is choosing whether to place climbing gear. You can place ropes and climbing spikes to make hard spots easier. Using gear now reduces risk right away. Saving gear is risky now, but it can be a lifesaver later.
- Treat status effects

- The player is choosing who and when to use these healing items. Injury from falls, burns, frost, and poison can lower your max stamina. These effects can often be cured by items or resting. You can give it to the player who is struggling, because they may fall without it, but that can leave the best climber with low stamina, and then nobody can finish the hard parts. If the best climber uses the healing item, the weaker player might still fall, but at least one strong player can keep climbing and set ropes to help later.
- Manage inventory weight
 - Carrying weight can reduce your maximum stamina, so sometimes you must drop items. The player is choosing what to carry: Do you carry extra tools and food, or stay light for climbing? The player is also choosing what to drop: Do you drop healing, food, or climbing gear?

PEAK creates meaningful player choice by constantly making the player balance short-term safety against long-term survival. Almost every action uses a limited resource, whether it is stamina, food, healing items, climbing gear, inventory space, or time. Because players do not know exactly what challenges will appear later, there is rarely one obviously correct decision. In multiplayer, these choices become even more interesting because players must also decide how to distribute resources and risk between teammates.